



Floaty florals When Welsh designer Laura Ashley shifted from furniture coverings to feminine clothing, her signature style was defined. Pretty floral prints in natural cotton or needlecord resulted in classic romantic dresses.



Halterneck hit Empire-line halterneck dresses were the ultimate in hippie chic. This 1974 example has a deep scoop at the back, but it is the pattern that catches the eye. The floral print has contrasting paisley panels sewn into the handkerchief skirt.



True blue A nod towards Laura Ashley's style, this Indian print design in dark blue is fitted to accentuate the waist. The square neckline and flared short sleeves give the suggestion of a child's Victorian pinafore.



Stitching satin British designer Zandra Rhodes produced a series of textiles, called Knitted Circles, with motifs taken from knitting and embroidery stitches. The distinctive motifs are seen on this screen-printed kaftan-style dress.



Berry best Inspired by Ossie Clark, this strawberry-print dress flatters the female form while showing just a hint of flesh around the neck and bodice. The wraparound skirt ties at the back with a matching sash waistband.